Do Now · retrieval

Lesson 160 · Investigatory Powers: RIPA 2000, Modern Safeguards and Ethics

Name: _____ Class: _____ Date: _____

Answer four retrieval questions before reviewing earlier learning.

Q1

Does giving attribution automatically permit copying protected software or images?

Q2

Why does the TLS padlock not guarantee a site is honest?

Q3

What is the purpose of an operating system's memory management?

Q4

What is referential integrity?

New Learning · key ideas

The important knowledge from today's lesson. Read, annotate, and explain it.

Core idea 1

OCR historic reference — RIPA 2000 sets out specified investigatory powers and safeguards; provisions have changed over time.

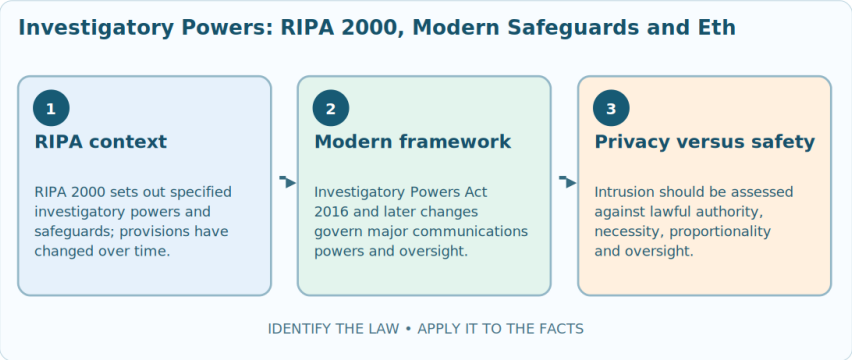
Core idea 2

Current landscape — Investigatory Powers Act 2016 and later changes govern major communications powers and oversight.

Core idea 3

Weigh safeguards — Intrusion should be assessed against lawful authority, necessity, proportionality and oversight. A different OCR requirement, 1.5.2 , considers broader ethical choices: a legally permitted technology can still introduce censorship, biased decisions, intrusive monitoring or avoidable environmental harm.

Key visual · complete concept



Annotate the key visual

Explain which labels or features show the main process.

New Learning · applying the ideas

Vocabulary · use the correct technical terms

RIPA 2000 — Regulation of Investigatory Powers Act 2000, historically specified by OCR.

IPA 2016 — Investigatory Powers Act 2016, governing major modern powers.

necessity — Intrusive step is needed for a legitimate legal aim.

proportionality — Intrusion is proportionate to the objective and circumstances.

Check your understanding

Explain one key process in your own words using two of the terms above.

More animated examples are available in the original online lesson.

I Do · worked example

Problem

A public authority requests covert interception of communications to investigate a serious threat. Is 'for public safety' alone an adequate legal justification?

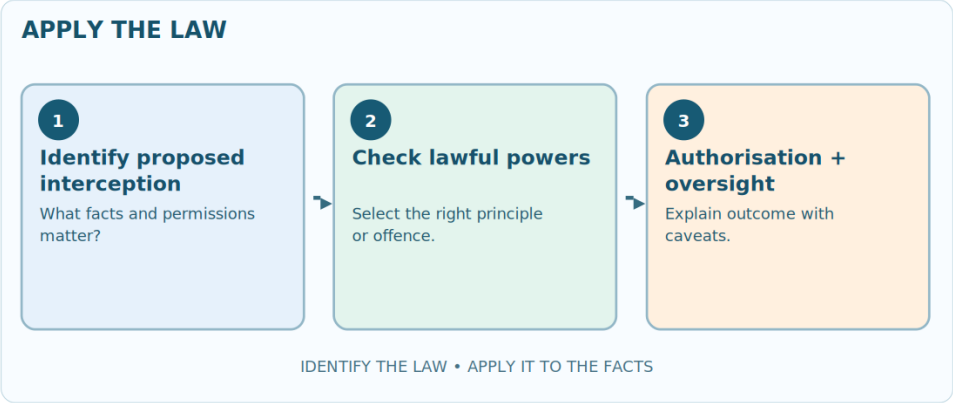
Follow the worked method

1. Identify proposed interception — Identify the relevant facts, purpose and authority.

2. Authorisation + oversight — No. Relevant statutory powers, lawful authorisation, necessity, proportionality and appropriate safeguards/oversight must be considered. Exact procedures depend on activity and legal power. OCR names RIPA 2000, while IPA 2016 now covers major investigatory communications powers.

3. Model a proportionate decision — Publish clear rules, distinguish criticism from harassment, review disputed removals and offer an appeal route. Explain which safeguards are legal obligations and which are additional ethical choices .

Source model · final illustrated step



Why this method works

Identify the decision, rule or invariant that makes the method correct.

We Do · Try → Discuss → Improve

TRY independently in BLACK PEN; compare methods with a partner; improve your reasoning.

Guided problem · TRY

Managed school devices
Identify the relevant facts, purpose and authority.

DISCUSS

Compare how you reached the answer. Where could someone make an error?

IMPROVE

Add one precise correction or a stronger reason. Answers are not printed here.

You Do · independent practice

Answer these selected original questions in BLACK PEN. Other exam tasks remain online.

Question 1

State why RIPA 2000 appears in OCR H446 1.5.1 and name one modern related Act. [6]

Question 2

Explain necessity and proportionality in the context of a proposed surveillance measure. [6]

Check that you have used the technical terms and explained your decisions.

You Do · extended practice

Answer these selected original questions in BLACK PEN. Other exam tasks remain online.

Question 3

A public authority wishes to inspect communications data during a serious investigation. Assess four issues it must consider before taking action. [8]

Check that you have used the technical terms and explained your decisions.

Exit Ticket · reflect and retrieve

Exit Ticket

Any school or authority may secretly intercept communications whenever it believes doing so is useful.

Use key vocabulary from memory

1. Explain RIPA 2000 in your own words.

2. Explain IPA 2016 in your own words.

3. Explain necessity in your own words.

Confidence and next step

How confident are you? Thumbs up / side / down

Which question would you improve after checking the classroom model?

Check answers after the lesson using the teacher-guided source models.